GDD: "GRAP Stage 4" (working title)

Game jam entry. Theme: EVERYTHING IS TEMPORARY. Solo dev. Deadline Sunday 4 Oct 2026, 18:00 IST.

Other title ideas: *"11 Mahine Ka Agreement"*, *"Temporary Diversion"*, *"Work In Progress Since 2009"*

Design rule: ship something. If a feature isn't needed to finish a run, it's a stretch goal.

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0. Context and constraints

- **Time:** Friday is out. Saturday is about 11 focused hours and Sunday about 7, with a hard upload by **16:30 IST**.
- **Engine:** Unity 6 (6000.5.9f1), URP 2D project **"Kadak Chai"**, exported to **WebGL** for itch.io.
- **Format: portrait**, 9:16 at a 1080×1920 reference resolution, embedded at 540×960 on itch. It plays with just a mouse or a tap.
- **Reference:** *Capybara Go* (iOS). We copy its structure: a day-by-day story log, auto-battles, and choices between fights.

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1. High concept

You're the **New Kid from Out of Town**, and you've just signed an **11-month rent agreement** in Delhi NCR. In this game an 11-month lease lasts **11 days**. Each day brings one event: a fight, a ridiculous situation with a choice, or a chai break. Survive all 11 days and get the **one stamp** from the **Babu** at the Sarkari Daftar before the lease runs out.

Theme hook: in NCR, "temporary" things are permanent: barricades, diversions, a flyover under construction since forever. But everything *you* have is temporary: your powers, your buffs, the air quality, the lease itself.

Tone: affectionate roast of situations and archetypes (broker, RWA aunty, tech bro, babu, Maamu). **No real named politicians, religions, or communities.**

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2. Core loop (one "day")

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Day card appears in the log  →  press the big button
   ├─ FIGHT:  auto-battle plays out (~10–20 sec)  →  Victory card + EXP
   ├─ EVENT:  joke text + 2 choice buttons        →  stat/skill/item outcome
   └─ CHAI BREAK: heal + a joke
Level up?  →  "Astrologer Baba" offers 3 skills, pick 1
Press "Next Day"  →  hero walks a few steps, next card
```

- **Run:** 11 days, about **10–15 minutes**.
- **Losing** a fight shows a *"Come Tomorrow"* card and **restarts that day** at full HP. Judges must be able to see the ending.

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3. Theme mechanics: "Everything is Temporary"

3.1 Skills on a lease (the core hook)

- Each skill you pick lasts a set number of days, shown as a chip with the days left, for example *"Pressure Horn: 3 days"*.
- When it expires, a card says *"Your Pressure Horn's lease has ended. The landlord kept the deposit."*

- So the build keeps changing, and nothing you own lasts. That one rule is the theme.

3.2 AQI of the day

- A dial at the top shows the AQI, which changes **once per day** (random, pushed up or down by events). Each band applies one rule to that day's fight:

AQI	Stage	Rule for today's fight
0–200	"Rare Good Day"	Hero +20% ATK. NPCs are suspicious.
201–300	GRAP 1	Enemies +10% ATK
301–400	GRAP 2	Everyone has a 15% miss chance (can't see anything)
401–450	GRAP 3, "Construction Ban"	Skills trigger half as often
450+	GRAP 4, "Odd-Even"	Hero attacks only on odd rounds, enemies only on even

- Every stage change also shows a fake news ticker line, e.g. *"BREAKING: Schools shut, offices open, logic suspended."*

3.3 Running gags as event cards

- **The Barricade** blocks the road in every zone, more decorated each time (garland, then a poster, then a birthday banner). You can't fight it, only choose a detour.
- **Delivery Wale Bhaiya** is "2 min away" in one card per zone. He arrives in the credits.

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4. Auto-battle

- **Layout:** hero (and Pinky Aunty once she joins) on the left, 1–3 enemies on the right.
- **Rounds:** the hero acts, then each enemy acts, up to **15 rounds**. Not winning by round 15 counts as a loss.
- **Every attack** is a basic hit plus a chance that each owned skill triggers. A triggered skill shows its name in floating text and a big damage number.
- **Damage:** `ATK × skill power × random(0.9–1.1) − DEF/2`, minimum 1.
- **Speed:** a 2× speed toggle.
- **No input during fights.** All player decisions happen between fights.

4.1 Skills (pool of about 10, picked from Astrologer Baba)

Skill	Effect	Lease
Pressure Horn	30% chance: extra hit ×1.5	3 days
Anti-Smog Gun	25%: hit all enemies ×0.8	3 days
Duct-Tape Fix	every 4 rounds: heal 20%	4 days
"Do You Know Who My Father Is?"	15%: ×3 hit, 20% chance to hit yourself	2 days
Kadak Chai	+25% ATK for 3 rounds at fight start	3 days
N95 Mask	ignore AQI penalties	4 days
Jugaad Shield	first 3 hits each fight do half damage	3 days
Wrong-Side Shortcut	always act first, +15% dodge	3 days
Forward This Message	20%: enemy is confused for 1 round	3 days
Haggling	20%: steal 10% of the enemy's ATK	3 days

4.2 Companion: Pinky Aunty from the RWA WhatsApp group

- She joins through an event on Day 2 (*"Beta, I will help, but first forward this to 10 people."*).
- Like the falcon in Capybara Go, she acts on her own every 3 rounds: a *Good Morning Flower Image* heals, or a *Complaint to Society Secretary* hits hard.

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5. The 11 days (hand-authored, not procedural)

Zones are just a background and a group of days. The sequence is a fixed list in JSON, so it's easy to tune and the jokes land in order.

Day	Zone	Type	Content
1	Dilli	Fight	Wrong-Side Scooty Uncle
2	Dilli	Event	Pinky Aunty joins
3	Dilli	Event	Barricade #1 / Maamu: *"Closed temporarily."* *"Since when?"* *"2011."*
4	Dilli	**Boss**	**The Broker**: heals every 3 rounds (*"Owner is very nice"*) and drains HP as brokerage
5	Noida	Fight	Monkey Gang (steals your shortest-lease skill for the fight)
6	Noida	Event	A baraat blocks the expressway. Dance? (+ATK, –HP)
7	Noida	Fight	Firecracker Ban Violator (pushes AQI up) + Society Guard
8	Noida	**Boss**	**The Startup CEO**: *"PIVOT!"* every 2 rounds, switching between B2C mode (high ATK) and B2B mode (high DEF). HP label is "Runway".
9	Daftar	Chai break	Heal, plus Delivery Bhaiya "2 min away"
10	Daftar	Event	The photocopy shop: choose which document to bring (decides one buff for the boss)
11	Daftar	**Final boss**	**The Babu**: *"Lunch Break"* (invulnerable for rounds 1–2), then *"Come Tomorrow"* (revives once at full HP)

Ending: the stamp reads **"VALID FOR 11 MONTHS."** Your lease ends that same moment. The credits roll as a traffic challan.

Stretch goal: a Gurugram zone (Days 5–8 → Gurugram, with Noida after it) with a flooded road and a Builder boss whose "Possession Date" keeps moving.

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6. Writing and humour

- **The log cards do the comedy:** short text, one or two orange keywords, at most 2 choice buttons.
- **Language:** English with Hinglish punchlines.
- **Budget:** about **40 cards** (11 day intros + outcomes + victory/skill-expiry/level-up flavour). They live in `dialogue.csv` and can be written on your phone.
- **Sample lines:**
    - Tech bro enemy intro: *"I'm not stuck in traffic, I'm doing async commuting."*
    - Victory over Scooty Uncle: *"He reverses into oncoming traffic. Nobody is surprised."*
    - Babu: *"Original + 3 photocopies + self-attested + attested by gazetted officer + your soul."*

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7. Art plan (the biggest risk, so the job is made small)

7.1 What's needed (about 25 images total)

Asset	Count	Notes
Characters	10	New Kid, Pinky Aunty, 5 enemies, 3 bosses. **One static image each.** No parts, no rigging, no animation frames.
Backgrounds	3	Dilli, Noida, Daftar. One wide strip each, which scrolls a bit while the hero walks.
UI	~6	Log card panel, big button, stat strip, day-track icons (fight / event / chai / boss), AQI dial
Skill icons	~10	Small and simple. Could be emoji-style.
Font	1	**Baloo 2** (Google Fonts, OFL): round, friendly, and has a Hindi feel

7.2 Style: "sticker" chibi (like Capybara Go)

- Big head, tiny body, **flat colours, a thick dark outline, and a white sticker border**. Max 3–4 colours per character.
- Build them from **circles and rounded rectangles** in Figma, Inkscape, or Photopea. You don't need drawing skill: a broker is a circle head, a gold chain, and a phone. About 15 minutes per character.
- **Identity comes from one prop:** the Broker's phone, the CEO's hoodie and laptop, the Babu's rubber stamp, Maamu's whistle, the Scooty Uncle's helmet on the elbow.

7.3 All animation is code (no frames)

- **Idle:** a slow squash-and-stretch bob.
- **Attack:** lunge forward and back.
- **Hit:** flash white and shake.
- **Death:** tip over, then fade.
- **Walk to next day:** bob faster while the background scrolls.

This is exactly how Capybara Go's sprites read in the video, and it costs **zero art time**.

7.4 Fast sources

- **Backgrounds:** take phone photos of real NCR scenes (barricades, metro pillars, a sarkari office corridor), posterize them, and lay them behind the stickers. It looks authentic and takes minutes. Use only your own photos.
- **UI:** the free **Kenney UI packs** (CC0). Just recolour them.
- **Icons: game-icons.net** (CC BY; credit it on the itch page).
- **AI-generated art:** check the jam rules first. Many jams ban it or require disclosure.

7.5 Order of work

- **Saturday: placeholders only.** Coloured capsules with a name label. Gameplay must never wait on art.
- **Sunday morning: art block.** Swap in the stickers. If time runs out, the placeholders are flat-coloured blobs with faces, and that still fits the style.

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8. Audio (stretch goal)

- **Music:** 1 loop for the day log and 1 for battle (BeepBox or royalty-free, with a dhol/shehnai flavour).
- **SFX:** mostly mouth-made: honk, stamp thunk, "Arre!".
- **Barks:** 2–3 short voice clips per boss that play when they appear. That's all the voice acting.

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9. Implementation (Unity 6), already scaffolded

```
Assets/_Game/
  Resources/Data/   days.json (the 11-day script), combatants.json, skills.json, dialogue.csv
  Resources/Art/    Characters/<id>.png, Backgrounds/<zone>.png   (drop-in, auto-loaded)
  Resources/Audio/  SFX/, Music/, Barks/                          (drop-in, optional)
  Scripts/Core/     Run + RunState (day loop, leases), Effects, Aqi, GameData, RunSimulator
  Scripts/Battle/   AutoBattle (simulates a fight into events), Combatant, StatusEffect
  Scripts/View/     GameController (UI + flow), BattleView (replays events), StoryLog, Puppet, Art, AudioKit, U
  Scripts/Editor/   "Kadak Chai" menu: Build Main Scene, Build WebGL, Simulate 500 Runs
```

- **Everything is data-driven:** days, enemies, skills and card text come from JSON/CSV.
- **One scene,** with the UI built in code. Art and audio are swapped by dropping files into place.
- **The rules are engine-free C#,** so the balance simulator runs 500 games in seconds.
- **Skills** have `daysLeft`. Buffs have `roundsLeft`. Those two counters are the whole "temporary" system.
- **Debug:** set `Debug Start Day` on the Game object, or add `?day=11` to a WebGL URL, to jump straight to a boss.

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10. Schedule

When	Hours	Goal
Fri (tonight)	~1	Write day cards on your phone. Scaffold is set up.
Sat 09–12	3	Auto-battle with placeholder capsules: round loop, damage popups, win/lose
Sat 12–15	3	Day loop: story log, big button, event choices, day track, JSON day script
Sat 15–18	3	Skills (pick 1 of 3, triggers, lease expiry), AQI of the day, Pinky Aunty, 3 boss gimmicks
Sat 18–20	2	Full run playable start to credits with placeholders. **This is the shippable build.**
Sat 20–21	1	WebGL build uploaded to itch (as a private draft)
Sun 09–12	3	Art: 10 stickers, 3 backgrounds, UI reskin
Sun 12–14	2	Finish all cards, balance, juice (screen shake, ticker, 2× speed)
Sun 14–15:30	1.5	Music/SFX, boss barks
Sun 15:30–16:30	1	Playtest with 2 friends, fix, **upload**
16:30–18:00	buffer	Itch page, screenshots, GIF, submit

Cut list (cut from the top first)

1. Gurugram zone (already a stretch goal)
2. Barks and music (keep 3–4 SFX)
3. Pinky Aunty companion
4. AQI rules (keep the dial and ticker as flavour)
5. Boss gimmicks beyond one each

Never cut: the 11-day lease, skills that expire, the story log jokes, the Babu finale.

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11. Done criteria

- The WebGL build runs on itch in Chrome and Safari, and a full run reaches the credits in under 15 minutes with no softlock.
- At least 2 skills expire visibly during a normal run.

- Two friends can finish it without help.
- The itch page has a 3-bullet "How this fits the theme" blurb (§3).